

Catherine Cruickshank

[linkedin.com/in/catherinecruickshank](https://www.linkedin.com/in/catherinecruickshank) · ce.cruickshank@icloud.com · Amsterdam, NL



CFO/COO with a track record of scaling high-growth ventures, delivering operational turnarounds, and leading strategic exits. 10+ years of senior executive experience in PE/VC-backed and founder-led businesses (€5–100M revenue, up to 150 FTE) across SaaS, EV infrastructure, telecom, and renewable energy.

Combines deep financial expertise with hands-on operational leadership to drive revenue growth, secure funding, and build the systems that make scale possible. Led M&A deals, funding rounds, and successful exits up to 80M enterprise valuations. Built cross-functional teams, structured international entities (NL, DE, UK), and implemented automation and AI to boost efficiency - turning loss-making businesses into profitable, exit-ready operations. Increasingly focused on deploying AI and agentic automation within finance operations - replacing manual processes with intelligent systems for reporting, forecasting, and reconciliation.

Currently open to a C-level leadership role where financial rigour, operational drive, and entrepreneurial mindset make the difference.

Experience



CEFAB Management · Director · Aug 2021 - Present

Fractional CFO/COO partnerships with growth-stage businesses (€3–25M revenue) across SaaS, tech, and services sectors. Building financial and operational systems for scale, supporting M&A execution, funding and exit preparation, and international expansion. Board and interim leadership roles alongside portfolio management.

- Building AI-enhanced finance and operations functions: implementing agentic workflows for FP&A, dashboards, reporting, and financial operations
- M&A support: deal execution, due diligence, integration
- Funding & exit preparation: investor relations, data rooms, valuation optimisation
- International expansion: cross-border structures, process harmonisation
- Team development: coaching finance and operations teams



Triple Solar · CFO & COO · Jul 2023 - Jun 2025

Dual CFO/COO role driving 2x operational scale-up across Dutch and German entities in the renewable energy sector.

- Led M&A strategy, acquisition, and full integration of German subsidiary - aligned governance, systems, and teams across borders
- Integrated group-wide automation and AI programs, achieving 40% overhead reduction
- Structured financial operations across NL/DE, ensuring compliance and scalability
- Strategic financial oversight and organisational design with supervisory board and shareholders
- Built and led cross-functional finance and operations teams across both entities



Fleks · CFO & Managing Director · Oct 2021 – May 2023

Full P&L ownership of VC-backed SaaS scale-up. Brought in to turn around a loss-making business and prepare for exit.

- From loss-making to EBITDA-positive in 12 months - restructured cost base and optimised unit economics
- Internalised development team → 35% cost reduction + faster delivery
- Restructured legal, sales, and finance frameworks to enable scale and reduce compliance risk
- Led due diligence and exit preparation → successful acquisition secured



Unravel • CFO & Managing Director • Oct 2021 – May 2023

CFO/MD of tech agency spinout (servicing Fleks and portfolio companies). Built standalone business from scratch and prepared for sale.

- Shifted from ad-hoc projects to long-term retainers → predictable revenue + higher margins
- Implemented standalone finance and ops systems (previously shared with parent)
- Achieved profitability in under 12 months from spinout
- Structured business for independent sale/acquisition

Parallel role with Fleks - demonstrated ability to lead multiple businesses simultaneously.



Greenflux • Director Finance & Business • May 2020 – Sep 2021

Built and led finance and business ops for a fast-scaling EV infrastructure SaaS platform. Hired to professionalise finance ahead of exit.

- Built finance and business ops function from the ground up
- Designed EU-wide corporate structure handling €7M cross-border transactions — mitigated multi-jurisdictional tax risk
- Implemented agile FP&A and project tracking frameworks to support revenue growth
- Prepared business for strategic exit → €60-80M enterprise valuation achieved
- Successful exit to corporate buyer within 12 months of joining



Telio • NL Finance Director & Group Controller • May 2017 – Apr 2020

Dual role: Finance Director for Netherlands operations + Group Controller across 20 entities spanning Europe, Australia, and North America.

- Full P&L ownership and financial management for Dutch entity
- Financial consolidation and reporting across 20 international entities
- Standardised group reporting and controls → 60% reduction in reporting cycle time
- Harmonised budgeting and forecasting practices across regional teams
- Advised Group CFO on strategic financial planning and capital allocation
- M&A team member: target selection, acquisition execution, and post-merger integration

Earlier Career - 2010 – 2017

Founder & Business Advisor

Founded, scaled, and successfully exited a language services business after relocating to Amsterdam. Also: financial and operational strategy advisory for SMEs, and general management of the Ritz Cinema (Belper, UK). Brings an entrepreneur's perspective to CFO/COO work - understands what it's like on both sides of the table.

Education



University of London

London School of Economics
Banking & Finance



Harvard University

Exchange Semester
Economics

Languages

- Native English (mother tongue)
- (Almost) native Dutch
- Professionally proficient German (reading, listening)
- Professionally proficient French (spoken, listening)